

skyscraper (n) a very tall building containing offices or flats:
Skyscrapers started to appear in the 1930s.

structure (n) something large such as a building or a bridge that is built from different parts: *The large structure outside town is going to be the new stadium.*

suburban (adj) relating to an area or town near a large city but away from its centre, where there are many houses, especially for middle-class people: *Many people would love to live in suburban areas but can't afford it.*

surroundings (n pl) all the things that are present in a place and that form the experience of being there: *I wish I lived in more pleasant surroundings.*

urban (adj) relating to towns and cities, or happening there: *There needs to be more investment in urban areas.*

Unit 18

Reactions

acknowledge (v) to accept or admit that something exists, is true or is real: *He never acknowledges his mistakes.*

acknowledge (v) to thank someone for something they have done or given you, especially in writing or by saying it publicly: *We gratefully acknowledge the contributions of everyone who helped us.*

acknowledge (v) to show that you have seen someone or that you recognise them, for example by smiling or speaking to them: *They barely acknowledge each other in public.*

agonise (v) to spend a long time worrying and being upset about something: *For years I agonised over whether I could have helped my daughter.*

apathy (n) a feeling of having no interest in or enthusiasm about anything, or of not being willing to make any effort to change things: *Few people voted in the election, presumably just because of apathy.*

avoid (v) to try to prevent something from happening: *Try to avoid confrontation.*

avoid (v) to try not to go near someone or something: *We went early to avoid the crowds.*

avoid (v) to choose not to do something in order to achieve a better result: *When taking this medication it is advisable to avoid alcohol.*

behaviour (n) the way that someone or something behaves: *Anna was sick of her brother's behaviour.*

chuckle (n) a quiet laugh: *There were a couple of chuckles from one member of the audience.*

chuckle (v) to laugh quietly, especially in a private or secret way: *As she read her book, she chuckled softly.*

comfort (n) a physically relaxed state, without any pain or other unpleasant feelings: *The airline is keen to improve passenger comfort.*

comfort (n) a feeling of being less sad or worried about something than you were previously: *My mother was always there to offer comfort.*

comfort (n) a pleasant way of life in which you have everything you need: *Now he can live in comfort for the rest of his life.*

comfort (v) to make someone feel less sad, worried or disappointed: *He went upstairs to comfort the baby.*

conduct (n) the way someone behaves, especially in relation to particular rules or accepted ways of behaving: *Two players were sent off for violent conduct.*

conduct (v) to do something in an organised way: *The agreement doesn't allow you to conduct business from your home.*

consequence (n) a result or effect of something: *She said exactly what she felt, without fear of the consequences.*

contentment (n) the happiness you feel when you have everything you want and you enjoy your life: *He has found contentment and satisfaction in his work.*

cross (adj) angry: *The neighbours got cross every time we put our music on.*

dignity (n) the impressive behaviour of someone who controls their emotions in a difficult situation: *She faced all her problems with dignity.*

disgust (n) a very strong feeling of not liking something: *The idea of eating meat fills me with disgust.*

disgust (v) if something disgusts you, it is so bad or immoral that it makes you angry and upset: *Your whole attitude disgusts me.*

disillusioned (adj) disappointed because you have discovered that someone or something is not as good as you had believed: *Voters are very disillusioned with the democratic process.*

fed up (adj) annoyed or bored with something that you feel you have accepted for too long: *I'm fed up with this job.*

giggle (n) a high laugh, especially a nervous or silly one: *The sound of giggles came from the girls' room.*

giggle (v) to laugh in a nervous, excited or silly way that is difficult to control: *The children whispered and giggled all the way through the film.*

glance (n) a quick look at someone or something: *She had a quick glance at the newspaper as she gulped down her coffee.*

glance (v) to look somewhere quickly and then look away: *He glanced over his shoulder nervously.*

glimpse (n) an occasion when you see someone or something for a moment only: *The crowd were anxious for a glimpse of the President.*

glimpse (v) to see someone or something for a moment or not completely: *He glimpsed a short white-haired figure heading for the back gate.*

gloat (v) to show that you are happy and proud at your own success or at someone else's failure: *He was there to gloat over their defeat.*

glum (adj) looking sad, as if you expect something bad to happen: *You look a bit glum. Has something happened?*

grimace (n) an ugly expression that you make by twisting your face, for example because you are in pain or do not like something: *His tortured grimace showed he was in pain.*

grimace (v) to make an ugly expression by twisting your face, for example because you are in pain or do not like something: *She grimaced as she swallowed the medicine.*

grin (n) a big smile that shows your teeth: *'A great win,' Mike said with a broad grin.*

grin (v) to smile showing your teeth: *Ruth grinned at him as she waved goodbye.*

handle (v) to take action to deal with a difficult situation: *The government was criticised for the way it handled the crisis.*

impatient (adj) annoyed because something is not happening as quickly as you want or in the way you want: *'Come on!' said Maggie, becoming impatient.*

inertia (n) a situation in which something does not change for a long time: *There's so much inertia on the committee that nothing ever gets done.*

manners (n) traditionally accepted ways of behaving that show a polite respect for other people: *Children learn manners by observing their parents.*

manoeuvre (n) an action or movement that you need care or skill to do: *Dexter tried every manoeuvre he could to overtake the truck.*

manoeuvre (v) to move someone or something in a situation that needs care or skill: *Katherine's good at manoeuvring her car through heavy traffic.*

moan (n) an annoying complaint, especially about something that is not important: *I haven't got time to listen to your moans and groans.*

moan (n) a long low sound you make because of pain, sadness or pleasure: *She let out a low moan of anguish.*

moan (v) to complain about something in an annoying way: *Ben was moaning about his job again.*

moan (v) if someone moans, they make a long low sound because of pain, sadness or pleasure: *James continued to moan loudly as the pain intensified.*

mock (v) to make someone or something look stupid by laughing at them, copying them, or saying something that is not kind: *Are you trying to mock me?*

neglect (n) the failure to give someone or something the care or attention they need: *There's an important need to protect children from abuse and neglect.*

neglect (v) to fail to look after someone when you are responsible for them: *What should we do about parents who neglect their children?*

neglect (v) to fail to do something that you should do: *He couldn't neglect his duties as an officer.*

peep (n) a quick look at something: *I'll just take a peep inside.*

peep (v) to look at something quickly and secretly, usually from a place where you think you cannot be seen: *She tried to peep through the gates to see the garden.*

peer (v) to look very carefully, especially because something is difficult to see: *She was peering through the window.*

prevent (v) to stop something from happening or stop someone from doing something: *Regular cleaning may help prevent infection.*

rejoice (v) to feel very happy about something, or to celebrate something in a happy way: *Montaigne seemed to rejoice in the humiliation of others.*

resent (v) to experience angry, unhappy feelings because you think you have been treated unfairly or without enough respect: *The girls in the family resented all the attention that Peter was getting.*

resolute (adj) extremely determined: *We're resolute in our determination to oppose these measures.*

smirk (n) an unpleasant smile: *Wipe that smirk off your face!*

smirk (v) to smile in an unpleasant way because something bad has happened to someone else, or because you think you have achieved an advantage over them: *I know you've won, but there's no need to smirk.*

snap (v) to suddenly lose control and become extremely angry or upset because a situation has become too annoying or difficult: *She was bound to snap under all that pressure.*

snap (v) to speak to someone in a sudden, angry way: *'What do you want now?' he snapped angrily.*

tactic (n) a particular method or plan for achieving something: *The governor's tactics involved accusing his opponent of being too liberal.*

terror (n) a strong feeling of fear: *Thousands of islanders fled in terror yesterday as the volcano erupted.*

terror (n) violence used for making people very frightened in order to achieve political aims: *This is a deliberate campaign of terror.*

Health

administer (v) to give someone a drug or medical treatment: *The drugs are administered intravenously.*

admit (v) to take someone into hospital for medical treatment: *After collapsing, she was rushed to hospital, where she was admitted.*

agony (n) great pain: *William fell to the ground, writhing in agony.*

agony (n) a strong and unpleasant feeling, especially great worry or sadness: *Waiting for the results was agony.*

antidote (n) a substance that prevents a poison from having bad effects: *It's a snake bite. Quick – get the antidote!*

consultant (n) a senior doctor in a hospital who is an expert in a particular medical subject: *She's a consultant cardiologist.*

diagnosis (n) a statement about what disease someone has, based on examining them: *Her doctor made a diagnosis of appendicitis.*

inoculate (v) to protect someone against a particular disease by injecting a medicine containing a small amount of the disease into them, so that their body becomes immune to it: *None of the family had been inoculated against diphtheria.*

irritation (n) a painful feeling in a part of the body, often with red skin or swelling: *Some drugs can cause stomach irritation.*

numb (adj) a part of your body that is numb has no feeling: *After hours of sitting on the floor, her legs had gone numb.*

numb (adj) not able to react or to show your emotions, often because of an extreme shock: *I was numb with fear.*

nursing home (n phr) an institution where old people live when they are too old or ill to look after themselves without help: *My grandmother's moving into a nursing home next week.*

paralysis (n) the loss of the ability to move your body or a part of it, usually because of an injury or illness: *The syndrome can lead to sudden paralysis.*

plaster (n) a thin piece of cloth or plastic that is sticky on one side, and that you put on your skin to cover a cut: *I've cut my finger. Have you got a plaster?*

plaster (n) if a part of someone's body is in plaster, it has a hard cover around it to protect a broken bone: *One man had his leg in plaster, having broken it in an accident.*

prescribe (v) if a doctor prescribes a drug or treatment, they say you should have it: *The drug should not be taken unless prescribed by a doctor.*

prevent(at)ive medicine (n phr) medical examinations, treatments, advice, etc intended to prevent illness or discover it before it becomes serious: *The government should invest more in preventive medicine.*

prognosis (n) a doctor's opinion about the way in which a disease or illness is likely to develop: *What's the prognosis, doctor?*

sick leave (n phr) a period of time during which you do not work because you are ill: *Mr Jenkins is away on sick leave today.*

side effect (n phr) an effect of a medicine that is not intended and could be unpleasant: *The treatment has no significant side effects.*

syringe (n) a needle fitted to a plastic tube, used for taking blood from your body or for putting medicine or drugs into it: *Take the syringe and inject the patient.*

vaccine (n) a substance put into the body, usually by injection, in order to provide protection against a disease: *Is there an effective vaccine for meningitis?*

ward (n) a large room in a hospital with beds for people to stay in: *Jo is a staff nurse working on the maternity ward.*

Unit 20

Power

aggression (n) an angry feeling that makes you want to attack or defeat someone else: *You're going to have to learn to control your aggression.*

authority (n) the power to make decisions or tell people what to do: *You don't have the authority to do that.*

benign (adj) kind and nice: *He might seem benign, but keep an eye on him.*

bully (v) to frighten or hurt someone who is smaller or weaker than you: *The boss just tries to bully everyone in the office.*

bully (n) someone who frightens or hurts someone who is smaller or weaker than they are: *I was a bit of a bully when I was at school.*

command (v) to officially order someone to do something: *The general commanded the army to attack.*

command (n) an official order: *The dog understands my every command.*

conquer (v) to take control of land or people using soldiers: *The Spanish conquered South America in the sixteenth century.*

conquer (v) to gain control of a situation or emotion by making a great physical or mental effort: *I tried hard to conquer my fear.*

consent (v) to give approval for something: *You can't go on the school trip unless your parents consent to it.*

consent (n) permission to do something: *The police shouldn't be allowed to enter your house without your consent.*

controversy (n) a disagreement, especially about a public policy or a moral issue that a lot of people have strong feelings about: *There's a lot of controversy surrounding the new law.*

dictator (n) someone who uses force to take and keep power in a country: *How did the dictator come to power?*

dominate (v) to control something or someone, often in a negative way, because you have more power or influence: *Don't allow him to dominate the conversation all the time.*

eliminate (v) to get rid of something that is not wanted or needed: *Will we ever eliminate the threat from pollution?*

enforce (v) to make sure that a law or rule is obeyed by people: *It'll be impossible to enforce the new law.*

entitled (adj) having the right to do something: *Students are entitled to a special discount on books.*

exempt (adj) allowed to ignore something such as a rule, obligation or payment: *At the moment, women are exempt from national service.*

former (adj) used for describing someone or something that had a particular job, title, status, etc in the past, but not now: *The former Prime Minister of India is visiting the UK.*

impose (v) to introduce something such as a new law or new system, and force people to accept it: *These rules are being imposed without anyone's opinion being asked.*

inferior (adj) not as good as something else: *Street markets often sell inferior quality electrical goods.*

intimidate (v) to deliberately make someone feel frightened especially so that they will do what you want: *Richard often tries to intimidate people.*

label (v) to use a word or phrase to describe someone or something, especially one that is not completely fair or true: *Don't label all young people in the same way.*

label (n) a word or phrase that is used to describe someone or something, especially one that is not completely fair or true: *I wish people wouldn't try to put a label on me.*

label (n) a piece of paper or material fastened to an object that gives information about it: *I don't know what's in this tin because the label has come off.*

liberate (v) to give someone the freedom to do what they want, for example by taking them out of a situation in which their behaviour is controlled: *Leaving school and getting a job really liberated me.*

mainstream (n) ideas, methods or people that are considered ordinary or normal and accepted by most people: *Life can be more difficult if you're not part of the mainstream.*

mainstream (adj) considered ordinary or normal and accepted or used by most people: *Most mainstream politicians have dismissed the suggestion.*

master (v) to learn something thoroughly so that you know it or can do it very well: *It took me over ten years to master the piano.*

master (n) a man who has control over servants or other people who work for him: *Servants should show respect to their master at all times.*

minister (n) an official in charge of a government department in the UK and other countries: *The Minister responsible for this decision should resign.*

monarch (n) a king or queen: *The monarch represents the country abroad.*

prohibit (v) to officially stop something from being done, especially by making it illegal: *The sale of lottery tickets to children is prohibited.*

reign (v) if a king or queen reigns, they officially rule a country: *Queen Victoria reigned during a time of great change.*

reign (n) the period of time when a king or queen rules a country: *What's the longest reign of any king or queen?*

reinforce (v) to make an idea, belief or feeling stronger: *Stories like this in the media reinforce the idea that all young black men are criminals.*

reluctant (adj) not willing to do something: *I'm reluctant to invite Tracy to the wedding.*

resist (v) to oppose or fight against someone or something: *The Prime Minister resisted a lot of pressure to change his mind.*

resist (v) to stop yourself from doing something that you would very much like to do: *I can't resist chocolate!*

restrict (v) to keep something within strict limits: *Many parents restrict the number of hours their children watch TV.*

society (n) people in general living together in organised communities, with laws and traditions controlling the way they behave towards one another: *People have much more freedom in today's society.*

subject (v) to make someone experience something unpleasant: *They subjected the poor prisoner to torture.*

subject (n) an idea, problem, situation, etc that you discuss or write about: *What subject have you chosen for your essay?*

subject (n) someone who lives in a country that is controlled by a king or queen: *I'm proud to be a British subject.*

subjective (adj) based on your own feelings and ideas and not on facts: *That's just your subjective opinion.*

submit (v) to accept that someone has defeated you or has power over you: *The boy only stopped hitting me when I submitted.*

summon (v) to officially order someone to come to a place, especially a court of law: *She was summoned to appear before the court.*

superior (adj) better than someone or something else in quality or skill: *His early work is vastly superior to the later pieces.*

undermine (v) to make something or someone become gradually less effective, confident or successful: *This unfortunate incident undermines all the hard work we've put in.*

unrest (n) angry or violent behaviour by people who are protesting against something: *Politicians held a special meeting to discuss the unrest in the country.*

victimise (v) to treat someone in a deliberately unfair way: *It's not right to victimise someone in that way.*

vulnerable (adj) someone who is vulnerable is weak or easy to hurt physically or mentally: *I felt quite vulnerable walking home late at night.*

Social issues

abolish (v) to officially get rid of a law, system, practice, etc: *The law was abolished in 1963.*

advocate (v) to publicly support a particular policy or way of doing things: *Do you advocate corporal punishment in schools?*

alleviate (v) to make something less painful, severe or serious: *These measures are designed to alleviate suffering among the elderly.*

bureaucracy (n) a complicated and annoying system of rules and processes: *I started to set up my own business but there was too much bureaucracy.*

charity (n) an organisation to which you give money so that it can give money and help to people who are poor or ill, or who need advice and support: *There are one or two charities that I make regular donations to.*

class (n) one of the groups into which people in a society are divided according to their family background, education, job or income: *My family are very middle class in a lot of ways.*

community (n) the people who live in an area: *Politics should begin in the local community.*

convict (v) to prove in a court of law that someone is guilty of a crime: *He was convicted of murder.*

convict (n) someone who is in prison because they have committed a crime: *Two convicts have escaped from the local prison.*

corruption (n) dishonest or illegal behaviour by officials or people in positions of power, especially when they accept money in exchange for doing things for someone: *They've started an investigation into corruption.*

- deterrent** (n) something that makes people decide not to do something by making them realise that something unpleasant could happen to them: *I think capital punishment serves as a deterrent.*
- heritage** (n) the art, buildings, traditions and beliefs that a society considers important to its history and culture: *It's important that we preserve our national heritage.*
- immigration** (n) the process in which people enter a country in order to live there permanently: *Is the level of immigration actually rising, or is it falling?*
- industrial action** (n phr) a protest in which workers show that they disagree with a policy of their employer, for example by striking: *Unless something changes, we'll be taking industrial action.*
- institution** (n) a large organisation such as a bank, hospital, university or prison: *It's hard spending all your life inside an institution like a children's home.*
- legislation** (n) a law or set of laws: *There is already legislation to prevent that.*
- prejudice** (n) an unreasonable opinion or feeling, especially the feeling of not liking a particular group of people: *Many women have had to deal with prejudice in the workplace.*
- prison reform** (n phr) changes intended to make the prison system fairer or more effective: *I'm a great believer in prison reform.*
- privileged** (adj) having advantages and opportunities that other people do not have, because you have a lot of money or high social status: *I suppose I come from quite a privileged background.*
- prosecute** (v) to officially accuse someone of a crime and ask a court of law to judge them: *The police decided not to prosecute and let him off with a warning.*
- state** (n) the government of a country: *The health system is the state's responsibility.*

Unit 22

Quality

- aggravate** (v) to make something bad become worse, especially a situation or a medical condition: *His headache was aggravated by all the noise.*
- better** (v) to achieve a better result than someone or something: *Bradman's average score of 96 has never been bettered.*
- better** (v) to improve something: *It's an important step towards bettering relations between the two countries.*
- blemish** (n) a mark or spot that spoils the appearance of something: *The painting was spoiled for me by a blemish on the frame.*
- chaos** (n) a situation in which everything is confused and in a mess: *There have been severe floods, bringing chaos to the region.*
- cheapen** (v) to make someone or something seem less valuable or respected: *This type of advertising cheapens the image of the brand.*
- contaminate** (v) to make something dirty, polluted or poisonous by adding a chemical, waste or infection: *Industrial sewage continues to contaminate our beaches.*
- decay** (v) to make or become gradually worse in quality, or weaker in power or influence: *Too much sugar will decay your teeth.*
- decline** (v) to become less or worse: *The number of people buying their own homes has declined.*
- defective** (adj) not made correctly or not working correctly: *The car was found to have defective brakes.*
- detrimental** (adj) harmful or damaging: *Overexposure to sunlight can have a detrimental effect on the skin.*
- devastate** (v) to seriously damage or completely destroy something: *Western India was devastated by a huge earthquake.*
- devastate** (v) to make someone feel very shocked and upset: *Mary's sisters were devastated by her disappearance.*
- enhance** (v) to improve something, or make it more attractive or more valuable: *The measures taken should considerably enhance the residents' quality of life.*

- evaluate** (v) to think carefully about something before making a judgment about its value, importance or quality: *The performance of each employee is evaluated once a year.*
- exacerbate** (v) to make a problem become worse: *Complaining will only exacerbate an already difficult situation.*
- exquisite** (adj) extremely beautiful and delicate: *It was an exquisite hand-painted vase from China.*
- first-rate** (adj) of the highest quality: *The service is first-rate.*
- flaw** (n) a mistake or fault in something that makes it useless, less effective or less beautiful: *There are serious flaws in the way we train our teachers.*
- ideal** (adj) of the best or most suitable type: *The fair provides an ideal opportunity for job seekers and employers to meet.*
- ideal** (adj) as good as you can imagine, and probably too good to be real: *In an ideal world there would be no poverty.*
- inadequate** (adj) not enough or not good enough for a particular purpose: *We are trying to provide basic education with inadequate resources.*
- invaluable** (adj) extremely useful: *The Internet is an invaluable resource for students.*
- optimum** (adj) best or most suitable within a range of possibilities: *The warm water provides the optimum conditions for breeding.*
- optimum** (n) the best or most suitable situation, level or amount: *The optimum we should be producing is 100 units per hour.*
- outclass** (v) to be much better than someone or something else: *The team was completely outclassed by the opposition.*
- prime** (adj) most important, most suitable or of the highest quality: *Our prime concern was the safety of our customers.*
- redeeming feature** (n phr) a positive quality which improves something that is not very good by including something that is good: *Smith's only redeeming feature is that he knows his job.*
- refurbish** (v) to improve a room or a building by cleaning and painting it, adding new furniture or equipment, etc: *They're planning to refurbish the teachers' room.*
- reinforce** (v) to make an idea, belief or feeling stronger: *The latest figures reinforce the view that economic growth is slowing.*
- reinforce** (v) to make a building, structure or object stronger: *Crews started work today to reinforce the seriously damaged bridge.*
- renovate** (v) to make something old look new again by repairing and improving it, especially a building: *The council's planning to renovate the old fire station.*
- rotten** (adj) something that is rotten has decayed: *There was a horrible smell of rotten eggs.*
- rotten** (adj) of a low quality, standard or ability: *She's a rotten singer.*
- rusty** (adj) a rusty metal object is covered in rust: *I don't know why you bought that rusty old car.*
- satisfactory** (adj) good enough to be accepted in a particular situation: *I have still not received a satisfactory answer to my question.*
- satisfactory** (adj) enjoyable and pleasing: *This new arrangement proved highly satisfactory to us all.*
- shambles** (n) something that is very badly organised and does not operate effectively: *Government corruption has left the economy in a shambles.*
- shoddy** (adj) shoddy work, services or products are of a very low standard: *The work they did on the new road was very shoddy in places.*
- sound** (adj) involving the use of good judgment, and therefore likely to be effective: *Administrators should make sure the programmes are legally sound.*
- sound** (adj) thorough: *You'll need a sound understanding of basic teaching skills before you enter the classroom.*
- stale** (adj) stale food such as bread is old and no longer fresh: *Wrap the bread up well or it'll go stale.*

streamline (v) to improve a business, organisation, process, etc by making it more modern or simple: *We need to streamline the whole process.*

strengthen (v) to make something stronger: *The bridge will need to be strengthened.*

surpass (v) to be better or greater than something else, or better than what was expected or hoped for: *Winning the gold medal surpassed my wildest dreams.*

ultimate (adj) happening at the end of a process or activity: *The incident affected the ultimate outcome of the war.*

ultimate (adj) as good or as bad as possible: *The house provides the ultimate luxury retreat.*

worsen (v) to become worse, or to make something worse: *The weather worsened, and temperatures fell.*

wreck (n) something that has been badly damaged: *The car was a wreck after the accident.*

wreck (v) to severely damage: *The town has been wrecked by the bombing.*

The arts

abstract (adj) abstract art expresses the artist's ideas or feelings rather than showing the exact appearance of people or things: *I'm not very keen on abstract paintings.*

abstract (n) an abstract painting or design: *You're not supposed to understand what it is; it's an abstract!*

auction (n) a public occasion when things are sold to the people who offer the most money for them: *They bought the paintings at auction in 1989.*

audition (n) a short performance in which you sing, dance or act so that someone can decide if you are good enough to perform in a particular play, concert, etc: *I've got an audition for the school play tomorrow.*

bestseller (n) a book that many people buy: *His first novel was a bestseller.*

collector's item (n phr) a rare or valuable object that collectors want to own: *Do you think this watch is a collector's item?*

curator (n) someone whose job is to look after the objects in a museum: *Ask the curator – he'll be able to tell you more about it.*

fine art (n phr) objects such as paintings that are created to be looked at because they are beautiful or interesting (note: the fine arts = activities in which people create beautiful or interesting objects, for example painting and sculpture): *I'm thinking of studying fine art at university.*

installation (n) a piece of art that consists of several different objects or pictures arranged to produce a particular effect: *There's an interesting installation at the Tate Gallery at the moment.*

lines (n pl) the words that an actor says in a performance: *He forgot his lines.*

lyrics (n pl) the words of a song: *I've written the music but haven't written any lyrics yet.*

masterpiece (n) an excellent painting, book, piece of music, etc, or the best work of art that a particular artist, writer, musician, etc has ever produced: *Vertigo is the film widely regarded as Hitchcock's masterpiece.*

paperback (n) a book with a cover made of thick paper: *His collection of poetry is now out in paperback.*

period (adj) typical of a particular historical time: *Will you be wearing period costumes in the play?*

period (n) a particular time in history: *Their collection is confined solely to the Roman period.*

priceless (adj) very valuable and impossible to replace: *These are priceless jewels.*

recital (n) a performance of music or poetry: *Are you coming to the piano recital tonight?*

retrospective (adj) relating to or considering things that happened in the past: *The show takes a retrospective look at the 1970s.*

retrospective (n) an exhibition that includes examples of a particular artist's work from their whole career: *I really want to go to the Norman Rockwell retrospective.*

score (n) the music written for a film, play, etc: *Who wrote the musical score for Star Wars?*

sketch (n) a drawing made quickly that does not have many details: *Draw a rough sketch of the dog.*

sketch (n) a short funny scene performed within a longer show: *She toured Europe with a programme of songs and sketches.*

sketch (v) to draw a picture quickly and with few details: *I'll just sketch a rough outline of the house.*

work of art (n phr) something such as a painting or sculpture that is of very high quality: *There are many priceless works of art in the Louvre.*

work of art (n phr) something that is made or done in a skilful or attractive way: *Her house is a real work of art.*

worthless (adj) not having any value or good qualities, or not useful: *The country's currency is nearly worthless.*

Unit 24

Relationships

adjacent (adj) next to or near something else: *The theatre is adjacent to the library.*

attach (v) to fasten or join one thing to another: *You need to attach these two parts.*

bond (v) to fix two things firmly together, usually with glue, or to become fixed in this way: *It's not easy to bond plastic and metal together.*

bond (n) the way that two surfaces are stuck together, usually with glue: *The bond should be strong enough to support quite a lot of weight.*

bond (n) something that gives people or groups a reason to love one another or feel they have a duty to one another: *We were at school together, so there's quite a strong bond between us.*

coexist (v) to live or exist at the same time or in the same place: *Two different species of bear coexist in this area.*

coherent (adj) a coherent statement is reasonable and sensible: *You need to rewrite your essay so that your argument is more coherent.*

compatible (adj) likely to have a good relationship because of being similar: *I suppose Lisa and I just weren't compatible.*

comprise (v) to consist of two or more things: *The country comprises a number of independent areas.*

compromise (v) to solve a problem or end an argument by accepting that you cannot have everything that you want: *Young children have to learn how to compromise.*

compromise (n) a way of solving a problem or ending an argument in which both people or groups accept that they cannot have everything they want: *You'll just have to find a compromise.*

conflict (v) if different ideas or opinions conflict, they cannot all be right or cannot all happen: *This statement conflicts with what the Prime Minister said earlier.*

conflict (n) angry disagreement between people or groups: *Many people have died in the conflict.*

confront (v) to go close to someone in a threatening way: *A man in a suit confronted me as I tried to enter the building.*

confront (v) to deal with a difficult situation: *It's best to just confront the problem head on.*

consistent (adj) not changing in behaviour, attitudes or qualities: *He might be strict, but at least he's consistent.*

contradict (v) to say that the opposite of what someone has said is true: *I wish you wouldn't contradict me all the time.*

contradict (v) if one statement, piece of evidence, story, etc contradicts another, they disagree and cannot both be true: *What the witness said contradicted the accused man's story.*

contrasting (adj) different from each other in a noticeable or interesting way: *They write in contrasting styles.*

cooperate (v) to work with other people to achieve a result that is good for everyone involved: *We can achieve more if we cooperate.*

correspond (v) to be the same as something else or very much like it: *The two accounts of the incident correspond with each other.*

dispute (v) to say that something such as a fact is not true or correct: *I'm not disputing the facts, just your interpretation of them.*

dispute (n) a serious disagreement, especially one between groups of people that lasts for a long time: *The dispute seems likely to continue.*

distinguish (v) to recognise the differences between things: *I couldn't distinguish between the expensive coffee and the cheap brand.*

diverse (adj) very different from each other: *Our English teacher knows a lot about quite a diverse range of subjects.*

divorce (v) to take legal action to end your marriage: *She divorced her husband about ten years ago.*

divorce (n) a legal way of ending a marriage: *I've been meaning to tell you for some time now that I'd like a divorce.*

equivalent (n) someone or something that has the same size, value, importance or meaning as someone or something else: *There's no equivalent for that word in English.*

equivalent (adj) of the same size, value, importance or meaning as something else: *We can either give you a refund or you can exchange the item for one of equivalent value.*

exclude (v) to deliberately not include something: *Excluding ourselves, we're inviting 18 people to the party.*

external (adj) coming from outside a place or organisation: *You'll be interviewed by an external examiner.*

external (adj) on or from the outside of something such as a building or someone's body: *This cream is for external use only.*

identify (v) to recognise someone and be able to say who they are: *The witness wasn't able to identify the man.*

identify with (v) feel that you can understand and share someone else's feelings: *I could really identify with the character of Melissa in the film.*

integral (adj) forming an essential part of something and needed to make it complete: *Learning to forgive is an integral part of growing up.*

integrate (v) to make someone become a full member of a group or society and be involved completely in its activities: *I think that people who come to this country should make an effort to integrate.*

interfere (v) to deliberately become involved in a situation and try to influence the way that it develops, although you have no right to do this: *Stop interfering in my relationship with Jane!*

intermediate (adj) in between two stages, places, levels, times, etc: *You can't become a pilot without going through a lot of intermediate steps along the way.*

intermediate (adj) at an academic level below advanced: *This course is aimed at intermediate learners.*

internal (adj) existing or happening inside an object, a building or your body: *We've decided to knock down one of the internal walls.*

intervene (v) to become involved in a situation in order to try to stop or change it: *The fight could have got ugly if the teacher hadn't intervened.*

intimate (adj) an intimate relationship is a very close personal relationship, especially a sexual one: *Martin seems to have problems being intimate with people.*

intimate (adj) relating to very private or personal things: *I record all my most intimate thoughts in my diary.*

involve (v) to include something as a necessary part of an activity, event or situation: *Getting your degree is going to involve quite a lot of hard work, you know.*

joint (adj) involving two or more people or done by them together: *We decided to open a joint bank account.*

liken (v) to say that someone or something is similar to someone or something else: *Mary likened herself to Bill Gates, and I suppose they have got one or two things in common.*

link (v) if people, things or events are linked, they are related to each other in some way: *Do you think this robbery is linked to the one that happened last week?*

link (v) to say or show that two things are related, or that one of the things causes the other: *The psychiatrist linked how I felt to the problems I'd had as a child.*

link (n) a connection between two or more people, places, facts or events, especially when one is affected or caused by the other: *There's a strong link between the power of the USA and the spread of English.*

merge (v) if two organisations merge, or you merge them, they combine to form one bigger organisation: *I might lose my job when the two businesses merge.*

mutual (adj) felt or done in the same way by each of two or more people: *John doesn't like me, and the feeling is mutual.*

negotiate (v) to try to reach an agreement by discussing something in a formal way, especially in a business or political situation: *We've managed to negotiate a discount of 20%.*

related (adj) if two or more things are related, there is a connection between them: *Your illness is related to the stress you are under at work.*

relative (adj) having a particular quality when compared to something else: *After the failure of his first film, the last one was a relative success.*

resemblance (n) if there is a resemblance between two people or things, they are similar, especially in their appearance: *Can you see the resemblance between me and my father?*

People

acquaintance (n) someone you know a little, who is not a close friend: *He's not really a friend, more of an acquaintance.*

adopt (v) to decide to start using a particular idea, plan or method: *I adopted the method the coach showed me and I played far better.*

adopt (v) to take someone else's child into your family and legally make him or her your own child: *After two years in a children's home, Adam was adopted by a very nice young couple.*

ancestor (n) someone who is related to you who lived a long time ago: *My ancestors all came from the same part of China.*

citizen (n) someone who has the right to live permanently in a particular country and has the right to the legal and social benefits of that country as well as legal obligations towards it: *The man took out his passport to prove he was an American citizen.*

companion (n) someone who is with you: *The prize is a holiday for you and a companion.*

dependant (n) a child or other relative to whom you give food, money and a home: *I couldn't believe it when I heard how many dependants he's got.*

descendant (n) a relative of a person who lived in the past: *Did I tell you that I'm a descendant of Lord Byron?*

empathise (v) to understand how someone feels because you can imagine what it is like to be them: *I've had a similar experience, so I can empathise.*

extrovert (n) someone who is very confident, lively and likes social situations: *Michelle is such an extrovert and loves meeting new people.*

foster (v) to look after a child as part of your family for a period of time because the child's parents cannot look after them: *My parents have fostered lots of children over the years.*

guardian (n) someone who is legally responsible for another person such as a child, whose parents have died: *You need to get the form signed by a parent or guardian.*

introvert (n) someone who tends to concentrate on their own thoughts and feelings rather than communicating with other people: *I'm more of an introvert and prefer to spend time on my own.*

partner (n) someone that you do a particular activity with: *Nadine and I are partners at tennis sometimes.*

partner (n) someone that you live with and have a sexual relationship with: *The invitation is for me and my partner.*

peer (n) someone who is of the same age as another person: *What your peers think of you can be very important.*

predecessor (n) the person who had a job or official position before someone else: *I hope to avoid making my predecessor's mistakes.*

sibling (n) your siblings are your brothers and sisters: *The elder sibling in a family is often more successful in his or her career.*

spouse (n) a husband or wife: *Each spouse is responsible for paying their own income tax.*

stepmother/son/etc (n) someone's stepmother/son/etc is their mother/son/etc because of a second marriage, not because of a biological connection: *When my dad remarried, I didn't really get on with my stepmother.*

successor (n) someone who has a position after someone else: *I hope my successor enjoys the job as much as I have.*

sympathise (v) to behave in a kind way and show that you understand someone's problems: *Why can't you sympathise with people, instead of blaming them for their problems?*

Unit 26

Preference

addiction (n) a strong need that someone feels to regularly take an illegal or harmful drug: *I developed an addiction to the medicine my doctor had prescribed for me.*

adore (v) to love someone/something very much: *I absolutely adore Indian food!*

anticipation (n) a feeling of excitement about something enjoyable that is going to happen soon: *I waited in anticipation for the show to begin.*

appeal (v) to ask people to do something or to behave in a particular way, especially in a difficult situation: *The Minister has appealed for people not to panic.*

appeal (v) if something appeals to you, you like it or want it: *A holiday in Ireland doesn't really appeal to me.*

appeal (n) a quality that something has that makes people like it or want it: *It's difficult to explain the appeal of this book.*

appeal (n) a request for people to do something or to behave in a particular way: *Police have made an appeal for witnesses to come forward.*

arbitrary (adj) not based on any particular plan or done for any particular reason: *The choice of date for the wedding was just arbitrary.*

aspiration (n) something that you want to achieve, or the wish to achieve something: *One of my aspirations is to travel the world.*

bear (v) if you cannot bear something, you cannot accept or do it because it makes you very unhappy: *I can't bear waiting in queues.*

compulsory (adj) something that is compulsory must be done because of a rule or law: *This course is compulsory for all students.*

content (adj) happy and satisfied with your life: *I'm quite content working here.*

craving (n) a very strong feeling of wanting something: *I had a sudden craving for chocolate ice cream.*

decline (v) to say politely that you will not accept something or do something: *The Prime Minister declined to answer questions.*

decline (v) to become less or worse: *The service in this hotel has really declined over the last couple of years.*

dedicated (adj) spending all your time and effort on something: *Kelly's very dedicated to her job and should go far.*

delight (v) to give someone a lot of enjoyment or pleasure: *I was delighted by the decision.*

desire (v) to want something: *It's quite common for people to desire what they can't have.*

desire (n) a strong feeling of wanting to have or do something: *She had a strong desire to work in the media.*

devote (v) to spend a lot of time or effort doing something: *Gordon's absolutely devoted to his kids.*

devote (v) to use something such as money for a particular purpose: *The government has devoted £10 million to the project.*

differentiate (v) to see or show a difference between things: *I'm colour blind so I have problems differentiating between red and green.*

envy (v) to have the unhappy feeling of wanting to be like someone else or have what they have: *Carla's brother envied her success and wealth.*

envy (n) the unhappy feeling you have when you want very much to do something that someone else does or have something that they have: *Envy can destroy a relationship.*

fancy (v) to want to have or do something: *Where do you fancy going tonight?*

fascination (n) the state of being very interested in something or attracted by something: *Carol's always had a fascination with insects.*

favour (v) to support an idea and believe that it is better than other ideas that have been suggested: *I favour the first suggestion.*

favour (v) to help someone and give them an advantage in an unfair way: *It's not fair to favour one student over another.*

favour (n) something that you do for someone in order to help them: *I don't suppose you could do me a favour, could you?*

greedy (adj) wanting more money, things or power than you need: *Maybe being sick will teach you not to be so greedy next time.*

impulse (n) a sudden strong feeling that you must do something: *I couldn't resist the impulse to kiss her.*

inclined (adj) feeling that you want to do something: *I am inclined to agree with you.*

liking (n) a feeling of enjoying or liking something: *I developed a liking for Chinese food when I lived there.*

mediocre (adj) average or below average in quality: *The restaurant was quite expensive, and the food was only mediocre.*

motive (n) the reason you do something: *What was the murderer's motive?*

mundane (adj) ordinary and not interesting or exciting, especially because it happens too regularly: *I'm thinking of changing jobs because working in the office has become quite mundane.*

obsessed (adj) considering someone or something as so important that you are always thinking about them, in a way that seems extreme to other people: *Oliver is totally obsessed with football.*

optional (adj) something that is optional is available or possible if you want it, but you do not have to have it or do it: *The sunroof is optional on this car, so you have to pay extra.*

passion (n) a strong enthusiasm or interest: *Alice had a passion for cooking.*

praise (v) to express strong approval or admiration for someone or something, especially in public: *I felt proud when the teacher praised my work.*

praise (n) an expression of strong approval or admiration: *Praise usually works far better than criticism.*

resolve (v) to make a formal decision, usually after a discussion and a vote at a meeting: *The company resolved to appoint a new managing director.*

sacrifice (v) to give up something important or valuable so that you or other people can do or have something else: *We've had to sacrifice a lot to put our children through private school.*

sacrifice (n) the act of giving up something important or valuable so that you or other people can do or have something else: *We all have to make sacrifices now that both your mother and I are out of work.*

strive (v) to make a lot of effort to achieve something: *You won't achieve your goals unless you strive towards them.*

taste (n) the ability to judge if something is good or bad in things like art, fashion and social behaviour: *Michael really has no taste in clothes.*

tempting (adj) used for describing something that makes you feel you would like to have it or do it: *It's very tempting to blame the government for everything that goes wrong.*

urge (v) to advise someone very strongly about what action or attitude they should take: *I would urge you to speak to a lawyer.*

urge (n) a strong feeling of wanting or needing to do something: *I suddenly felt an urge to run from the room.*

welcome (v) to say that you are pleased to accept or consider something such as an opportunity or a question: *We welcome the government's proposals.*

welcome (adj) if you are welcome or a welcome visitor at a place, people are pleased that you are there: *We were made to feel very welcome.*

worthwhile (adj) if something is worthwhile, it is worth the time, money or effort that you spend on it: *Why don't you watch less TV and do something more worthwhile with your time?*

yearn (v) to want something a lot, especially something that you know you may not be able to have: *Many people yearn to retire to the country, but not everyone manages it.*

Leisure activities

absorbing (adj) something absorbing is so entertaining that you give it all your attention: *The film was so absorbing that time simply flew by.*

casual (adj) relaxed and informal: *The party is quite casual, so don't dress too formally.*

exhilarating (adj) making you feel extremely happy, excited and full of energy: *The funfair was really exhilarating.*

fatigue (n) a feeling of being extremely tired, either physically or mentally: *Fatigue can lead to mistakes.*

idle (adj) not doing anything, when there are things that you should do: *Don't just sit there being idle – there's housework to be done.*

idle (adj) workers who are idle have no work: *The company is losing money all the time the workers are idle.*

indulge (v) to allow yourself to have or do something that you enjoy: *I decided to indulge myself and had a holiday in the Bahamas.*

lifestyle (n) the type of life you have, for example the type of job or house you have or the type of activity you like doing: *This product is ideal for today's busy lifestyles.*

leave (n) a period of time away from your job or the armed forces: *My brother comes out of the army on leave next week.*

outing (n) a short journey that you take for enjoyment: *Let's have an outing to the beach this weekend.*

pastime (n) something that you do regularly for fun in your free time: *I need to find a pastime that doesn't demand a lot of money.*

pursue (v) to follow a course of activity: *I'm thinking of pursuing a career in medicine.*

recreation (n) things that you do to enjoy yourself: *Sport can be a very social form of recreation.*

respite (n) a short period of rest from having to deal with a difficult or unpleasant situation: *We had a few days of respite from the hot weather, but it soon got warmer again.*

sedentary (adj) involving a lot of sitting and not much exercise: *I've got quite a sedentary job, so I like to go to the gym once a week.*

socialise (v) to spend time with other people socially, for example at a party: *We seem to have done a lot of socialising this month.*

solitude (n) the state of being completely alone, especially when this is pleasant or relaxing: *There's nothing like the peace and solitude you get when you're fishing.*

tedious (adj) boring and continuing for too long: *I couldn't believe how tedious that meeting was!*

trivial (adj) not very interesting, serious or valuable: *Fran always seems to think that her problems are important, while yours are quite trivial.*

unwind (v) to begin to relax after you have been working hard or feeling nervous: *I like to unwind with a good book in the evenings.*

venue (n) the place where an activity or event happens: *Have they chosen a venue for the wedding yet?*